Joe Karlsson

Principal Developer Marketing Engineer

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I run developer marketing for Connect AI, CData's MCP platform that connects AI agents to live enterprise data. Before that I spent about 15 years writing software, teaching it, and explaining it: front-end tech lead at Best Buy, bootcamp instructor in Honolulu, and developer relations at MongoDB, SingleStore, Tinybird, and CloudQuery. So far that's 100+ talks, including a TEDx talk.

EXPERIENCE

Principal Developer Marketing Engineer

2026 – Present

CData · Remote

MCP · AI Agents · SQL · REST APIs · SEO · Python

- Run developer marketing for Connect AI, CData's managed MCP platform that connects AI agents to live enterprise data, and own developer growth end to end
- Own the developer growth engine: technical docs, content, SEO and AEO, and how the platform is positioned to the engineers building on it
- Grow the organic developer adoption already forming around Connect AI
- Work with Product, Engineering, and Docs to keep the developer experience tight and make CData the obvious choice for connecting AI agents to enterprise data
- Build the demos, guides, and content that show developers how to solve their actual problem

Head of Developer Relations

2024 – 2026

CloudQuery (now env0) · Remote

GCP · AWS · Azure · ClickHouse · Python · SQL

- Built the Developer Relations function from scratch and ran all of it: content, community, docs, events, and video. Also owned the marketing site, docs, and developer hub, from the first Google result to trial activation
- Grew organic traffic 4x in under 3 months (about 1,350 to 5,600+ visitors a week). 426 keywords reached the top 10, including "cloud governance framework" (11 to 2) and "IT asset management" (43 to 7), and two target keywords hit #1
- Weekly search impressions reached 4.9x the previous all-time high, and trial signups rose 61% during the same push
- Rewrote the docs end to end: Quickstart completions went from zero to 25 a week, docs traffic grew 302%, and docs became a measurable activation channel
- Monthly MQLs hit 239% of target. Organic readers converted to trials and closed deals with no paid touchpoints
- Built a weekly audit that combined Search Console, Ahrefs, Plausible, and HubSpot, so every fix shipped as a tracked PR and I could tell which change moved which page
- Built the marketing team's Claude Code skills repo, which became shared internal tooling for both the CloudQuery and env0 brands, plus AI automations that produce sales one-pagers, discovery decks, and pitch slides
- Published 80+ technical posts on cloud security, IaC, and data engineering, ran a webinar series and the YouTube channel, and spoke at conferences
- Attended daily engineering standups and merged 480+ PRs into production
- After the merger with env0, ran the same content playbook on env0.com: organic traffic up 106% in 3 weeks

Senior Developer Advocate

2023 – 2024

Tinybird · Remote

SQL · ClickHouse · BigQuery · Kafka · Snowflake · Redshift · Python · GCP · AWS

- Built custom demos on prospects' own stacks for the Sales team, showing exactly where Tinybird fit their architecture
- Built proofs of concept, including a fraud detection system on GCP, BigQuery, and Kafka (33% fewer fraudulent transactions) and a BigQuery IoT optimization for a trucking company (40% lower compute cost, 30% faster data retrieval)
- Made technical content, videos, webinars, and workshops on real-time analytics for a developer audience
- Built community through workshops, online forums, and conference talks

Senior Developer Advocate

2021 – 2023

SingleStore · Remote

SQL · MySQL · Go · Node.js

- Ran content and video for developers moving from MySQL and PostgreSQL: tutorials, conference talks, and demos
- Set up co-marketing with cloud and tooling partners: joint content, webinars, and conference activations with their marketing and DevRel teams
- Ran conference presence end to end, from talk submissions and booth plans to the content afterward
- Worked with Engineering, Docs, and Sales to line content up with launches, keep it technically accurate, and support pre-sales

Senior Developer Advocate

2019 – 2021

MongoDB · Remote

JavaScript · Node.js · Python · React · MongoDB · AWS

- Keynoted MongoDB World and ran global conference strategy. When COVID canceled events, I moved the program to Twitch, YouTube, and TikTok
- Grew a 25K+ TikTok following (844K+ likes) and ranked #1 on "10 Must-Follow Developers on TikTok"
- Built demos like an IoT kitty litter box and an IoT digital graffiti board
- Wrote MongoDB's schema design, aggregation, and Atlas guides and videos, published on the MongoDB Developer Hub, The New Stack, and Medium

Front End Technical Lead

2017 – 2019

Best Buy · Minneapolis, MN

JavaScript · Node.js · React · Redux · Express · AWS

- Led a team of 10 engineers, QA, and product that owned Account Home on bestbuy.com, one of the top 3 eCommerce sites in North America (millions of users, thousands of requests per second)
- Led the full redesign and rebuild of Account Home with the UX, product, and backend teams
- Built an NLP chatbot that cut customer support call volume 25%

Full-Stack JavaScript Instructor

2015 – 2017

DevLeague · Honolulu, HI

ES6 · JavaScript · Node.js · React · Angular · PostgreSQL · AWS

- Taught full-stack JavaScript at Hawaii's first web development bootcamp, one of the top 10 coding bootcamps in the world
- Wrote the curriculum for its 12-week courses, led workshops, and mentored students into engineering jobs at local and national companies

SKILLS

LANGUAGES

JavaScript, TypeScript, Python, Go, Rust, SQL

DATABASES

MongoDB, PostgreSQL, MySQL, ClickHouse, Redis, Elasticsearch, SingleStore

CLOUD & DATA

AWS, GCP, Azure, BigQuery, Snowflake, Kafka, Airflow

AI & AUTOMATION

LLM APIs, AI Workflow Automation, Prompt Engineering, AI-assisted Content Pipelines, Sales Enablement Automation

FRONTEND

React, Redux, Astro, Tailwind CSS, D3.js

DEVREL & MARKETING

Technical Writing, Conference Speaking, Content Strategy, SEO, Conversion Optimization, Sales Enablement, Marketing Analytics, Community, Webinars

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Arts in Computer Science

2008 – 2012

Gustavus Adolphus College

GPA: 3.5 · Minors: Art History, Math